

Zikr Series: Evening Tea in the Indoor Veranda

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Size: 18.5 x 59.5 inches (47 x 151cm) approximately

Time taken: 4-5 weeks

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A patchwork runner

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My Nani (grandmother) awaits her evening tea. Her hands dance to a silent beat of interlacing loops – perhaps an oversized sweater for one of us to last a few years, or a warm winter vest. My Nana (grandfather) sitting beside her occasionally tunes in, listening to music, news, or other auditory narratives on his small, leather-bound radio.

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In the kitchen, I pour boiling water into the heated teapot. My Nani likes her tea hot and filled to the rim! As the tea brews, I contemplate my strategy, of getting the teacup, saucer, and spoon to my grandma. And that too, without any spillage and a drop in temperature!

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A task, perfected with years of practice requiring precision, speed, and stability, is complete. My grandparents are enjoying their tea and I, their company while sitting in the indoor veranda with the fan off. The tea must not get cold!

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The bird and block patterns are detailed using the running-stitch - a traditional hand-quilting technique, reminiscent of the hand-embroidery on Sindhi rallis (from rural Pakistan) - that binds the two cotton layers into a cohesive whole.

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Lightweight (two-layered) patchwork runner with no inner filling.

Hand quilted and machine stitched

Made entirely with 100% organic cotton (preshrunk)

Multipurpose and versatile

Can be used as an accent on any indoor space

Aftercare: Dry-clean only